Lab 12 - External References and PDF Import

Course: WSQ Technical Drawing with AutoCAD (TGS-2021005538) | Topic 04: Organizing Objects

Objective: LO4 - assemble drawings from shared reference content (A4, K4)

Goal

Repair and verify the relative Landscaping_REV1 Xref in the supplied office-layout host, then attach a title block and a PDF underlay and import vector geometry.

You'll produce

A host drawing whose landscaping Xref resolves from the lab folder, with an additional live title-block Xref and an imported PDF geometry sample.

Commands / tools: XREF/ATTACH, External References palette, PDFATTACH, PDFIMPORT

Files in this lab

- title-block.dwg - AutoCAD drawing file
- ex1-drawing-sheet.pdf - drawing sheet / reference (PDF)
- new-office-layout-with-xref.dwg - AutoCAD drawing file
- Landscaping_REV1.dwg - AutoCAD drawing file

Step-by-step

1. Keep new-office-layout-with-xref.dwg and Landscaping_REV1.dwg together, then open the host

```
OPEN new-office-layout-with-xref.dwg
```

2. Open External References and confirm Landscaping_REV1 is Found using a relative path

```
XR → Landscaping_REV1 → Saved Path: .\Landscaping_REV1.dwg
```

3. If unresolved, select a new path in the current lab folder, reload, and retain a relative path

```
XR → Change Path → Select New Path → Reload
```

4. Attach title-block.dwg as an additional Xref at 0,0, scale 1

```
XATTACH → title-block.dwg
```

5. Attach the supplied drawing-sheet PDF as an underlay and snap to its geometry

```
PDFATTACH → ex1-drawing-sheet.pdf
```

6. Import the PDF's vector geometry into the drawing and inspect the created objects

```
PDFIMPORT → select underlay area
```

Check your work

Both Xrefs show Loaded, Landscaping_REV1 uses a relative path and survives reopening the folder elsewhere, while PDFIMPORT produces editable AutoCAD objects from the underlay.